Social Media: Custom Fonts

In short

Fancy text from font generator websites isn't a real font. Screen readers read out each letter as a maths symbol, so the message makes no sense. Use the app's normal font for your name, profile, and posts.

What is it for?

People often use generator websites to make their text look unique (for example, 𝒄𝒖𝒓𝒔𝒊𝒗𝒆 [the word cursive, in fancy script letters] or 𝕓𝕠𝕝𝕕 [the word bold, in outlined letters]). However, these are not real fonts. They are mathematical symbols from the Unicode standard designed for equations, not language.

When a screen reader encounters this text, it does not read the word. It reads the mathematical description of every single character. 𝓗𝓮𝓵𝓵𝓸 ("Hello") becomes "Mathematical script capital H, mathematical script small e..." which makes the message impossible to understand.

How to support it

The kindest thing you can do is avoid these generators entirely for your display name, profile description, and post text.

- Use the default keyboard font provided by the platform. This ensures your text is readable and searchable.
- Since you cannot use bold or italics on most apps, highlight key words by capitalising only the first letter (for example, 'this is Really important') instead. Avoid writing whole words in capital letters, as they're harder to read.

Useful links

- Accessible Social: Just Not My Type, on why fancy text generators cause problems